



A COMMUNITY OF CHOICE

Planning and Development Department

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MEMO

To: Honorable Mayor Patrick Collins and Members of the City Council
From: Sophia Maes, Cheyenne DDA Administrator
Subject: Downtown Development Authority Proposed Budget - Fiscal Year 2026
Date: May 12, 2025

Background:

Attached is the proposed budget for fiscal year 2026 (July 1 to June 30). The proposed Governing Body review schedule is as follows:

- Introduction and Referral: May 12, 2025
- Finance Committee: May 20, 2025
- Final consideration: May 27, 2025

The budget represents a \$23,351.00 increase in mill levy assessment collections (\$487,000.00) and a decrease in interest earned (-\$400). The interest earned estimate is based on an estimated \$1 million dollars being left in the Wyoming Government Investment Fund (WGIF) which as of May 5, 2025, has a seven-day yield of 4.21%.

The proposed budget is a decrease in the budget from the prior year. The proposed budget of \$728,450 is \$349,599 less than fiscal year 2025, brings in \$131,450 from reserves, accounts for a \$30,000 grant from the Cheyenne-Laramie Co. Economic Development Joint Powers Board, and \$5,000 in funding from Laramie County. The City contributes \$251,025 covering all payroll, insurance, and benefits for employees. Additionally, other City staff provide support to DDA employees at no cost to the DDA. The City also provides physical office space and all things commonly associated with office space at no cost to the DDA board.

Highlights of the budget are below.

- **704 - Communications Plan: \$10,000 total**
 - A Communications Plan has been added to the FY26 Budget due to stakeholder feedback of poor historical communication. The amount may be amended in the future depending on RFP responses.
- **708 - Event Management (Visit Cheyenne Sponsored Events) \$30,000 total:**
 - **July, Downtown Express Shuttle, \$7,500** - The Downtown Express shuttle provides a free, convenient, and stress-free way for attendees to travel between Downtown Cheyenne and Frontier Park, reducing traffic congestion, impaired driving, and parking challenges. By offering reliable transportation, we make it easier for visitors to fully experience the best of Cheyenne, and provide them a convenient way to explore our vibrant downtown businesses. Ridership has increased steadily over the last 3 years.

- **July, Downtown Busker Program, \$2,250** - Launched in 2024 during CFD, the Downtown Busker Program received tremendous positive feedback from business owners to visitors, and the musicians themselves. Designed to enhance the visitor experience, support local artists, and drive foot traffic to downtown businesses, this initiative helps to transform public spaces into engaging, lively destinations.
- **July, Cheyenne Day, \$2,500** - Cheyenne Day provides a key opportunity to activate downtown with unique programming that encourages visitors to linger, explore, and experience what makes our city special. The variety of local events all contribute to an energetic, welcoming atmosphere that keeps people engaged throughout the day. By investing in Cheyenne Day, we create an environment where local businesses thrive, and residents take pride in their community. One of the most important aspects of Cheyenne Day is that it ensures everyone in our community can take part in the excitement of Frontier Days, regardless of their budget. While tickets to the rodeo, concerts, and carnival can be cost-prohibitive for some, Cheyenne Day offers a free and accessible way for locals and visitors to experience the spirit of the celebration and our incredible downtown. Attendance for this event has noticeably increased each year for the last 3 years.
- **December, Old West Holiday, \$17,750** - Old West Holiday brings families, friends, and visitors together to enjoy a unique seasonal experience. With free and low-cost activities such as Santas Horses at the Stables, visits with Santa and Mrs. Claus, and adult-focused experiences like the Running of the Santas, this multi-weekend experience ensures that everyone can participate in the holiday fun. By strategically placing events and activations across multiple weekends and throughout Downtown Cheyenne, Old West Holiday drives foot traffic to local businesses, encouraging holiday shopping and dining. The Santa Stop Sweepstakes, and our new digital passport program, incentivizes participants to explore shops, restaurants, and attractions.
- **739 - DDA Board Strategic Projects \$100,000 total**
This line item replaces the previous “Large Projects” line item and provides clarity that this is a special fund to carry our unique Board projects outlined in the 2024 Cheyenne DDA Plan of Development.
- **720 - Sponsorship \$45,000 total**
This line item represents sponsorships to other events and organizations that may make requests throughout the year. Allocations will be made on a request basis and sponsorship funds must face public facing activities and programs that have direct public benefit.
- **710 - Downtown Planter Program \$45,000 total**
This program has the same proposed budget as FY25 based on discussions with potential providers.
- **735 - Façade Improvement Program (FIP) \$100,000 total**
This is a preservation-based facade improvement program aimed at revitalizing historical structures by restoring and enhancing their exterior appearance while fostering economic growth through increased property values and tourism. The program has not been used in that capacity recently and staff intends to further assess and develop the program in the upcoming year. For budgeting and accounting purposes, we recommend that this and the Capital Improvement Grant program be independent line items.
- **736 - Capital Improvement Grant (CIG) Program \$200,000 total**
This program has been commonly used in recent years, comprising a majority of the grants awarded in recent years. In fiscal year 2025, \$250,000 was budgeted (\$500,000 approved) and it is expected that all grants will be allocated prior to the end of the fiscal year. For budgeting and accounting purposes, we recommend that this and the Façade Improvement Program be independent line items.

- **738 - Sidewalk Match Program \$85,000 total**

This is a line item from FY 25 to carry out the “Sidewalk Repair Assistance Program,” a response to the City Engineering Department’s sidewalk repair initiative.

The DDA Board approved this budget at their April 17, 2025 Regular Board meeting.

Attachments:

1. Resolution

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: "A RESOLUTION APPROVING THE BUDGET OF THE CHEYENNE DOWNTOWN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY FOR THE FISCAL YEAR BEGINNING JULY 1, 2025, AND ENDING JUNE 30, 2026."

WHEREAS, the Downtown Development Authority ("DDA") was created pursuant to Ordinance No. 2804 adopted by the Governing Body on July 9, 1984;

WHEREAS, Wyo. Stat. § 15-9-208(a) requires the DDA to propose a budget, which shall be administratively reviewed by the City prior to submission of the proposed budget to the Governing Body for approval;

WHEREAS, Section 2.76.050(C) of the city code provides that the DDA budget shall be subject to alteration, modification and approval by the Governing Body in accordance with the policies of the City;

WHEREAS, at its April 17, 2025, meeting the DDA Board approved the proposed budget for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2025, and ending June 30, 2026, a copy of which is appended to this Resolution and incorporated herein; and

WHEREAS, City staff has reviewed the proposed budget received from the DDA.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING, that the proposed budget of the Downtown Development Authority for the Fiscal Year beginning July 1, 2025, and ending June 30, 2026, as set forth in the attached information, entitled "Downtown Development Authority Proposed Budget - Fiscal Year 2026" in the total amount of seven hundred twenty-eight thousand four hundred fifty dollars (\$728,450.00), is hereby approved.

PRESENTED, READ AND ADOPTED THIS _____ DAY OF _____, 2025.

Patrick Collins, Mayor

(SEAL)

ATTEST:

Kylie Soden, City Clerk

Downtown Development Authority Proposed Budget - Fiscal Year 2026

Revenue	Approved	Proposed	Comment
405 - Laramie County	\$ 5,000	\$ 5,000	
410 - LCEDJPB	\$ 30,000	\$ 30,000	Helps with downtown Parking Design
415 - City of Cheyenne	\$ 25,000	\$ 25,000	COVID Rental Assistance Program Rollover. Must be spent by Dec 31, 2026
425 - Mill Levy	\$ 487,000	\$ 487,000	
430 - Wyoming Business Council	\$ -	\$ -	
440 - Fundraising	\$ -	\$ -	
445 - Other Income	\$ -	\$ -	
450 - Revenue from Reserves	\$ 131,450	\$ 131,450	From WGIF
920 - Interest Earned	\$ 50,000	\$ 50,000	
Grand Total Revenue	\$ 728,450	\$ 728,450	
Administration Expenses	Approved	Proposed	
500 - Computer Hardware & Software	\$ 3,000	\$ 3,000	
506 - Website	\$ 20,000	\$ 20,000	
510 - Accounting & Audit	\$ 21,000	\$ 21,000	For a third-party audit
525 - Rent	\$ -	\$ -	
530 - Cleaning	\$ -	\$ -	
550 - Office Supplies	\$ 500	\$ 500	
555 - Credit Card & Bank Fees	\$ 200	\$ 200	
575 - Insurance - Board & Officers	\$ 2,500	\$ 2,500	
580 - Education & Training	\$ 15,000	\$ 15,000	
591 - Utilities	\$ -	\$ -	
598 - Postage	\$ 2,500	\$ 2,500	
Administration Expenses Subtotal	\$ 64,700	\$ 64,700	
Operations Expenses	Approved	Proposed	
702 - Printing	\$ 1,000	\$ 1,000	
703 - Membership & Subscriptions	\$ 3,000	\$ 3,000	
704 - Communications Plan	\$ 10,000	\$ 10,000	
705 - Advertising and Marketing	\$ 5,000	\$ 5,000	
706 - Professional Services	\$ -	\$ -	
708 - Event Management	\$ 30,000	\$ 30,000	Visit Cheyenne sponsorship of Downtown Events
709 - Downtown Mural/Arts District Program	\$ -	\$ -	
710 - Downtown Planter Program	\$ 45,000	\$ 45,000	
711 - Downtown Banner Initiative	\$ 1,750	\$ 1,750	
712 - Graffiti Removal	\$ -	\$ -	
720 - Sponsorship	\$ 45,000	\$ 45,000	Includes Fridays on the Plaza and other public facing activities/programs that have direct public benefit.
735 - Façade Improvement Program Grants (FIP)	\$ 100,000	\$ 100,000	
736 - Capital Improvement Grant (CIG)	\$ 200,000	\$ 200,000	
738 - Sidewalk Match Program	\$ 85,000	\$ 85,000	
739 - DDA Board Strategic Projects	\$ 100,000	\$ 100,000	Reserved for DDA Plan of Development Projects
745 - Community Events	\$ 10,000	\$ 10,000	Two (2) DDA Hosted Events (Screen on the Green)
750 - Market Research	\$ 3,000	\$ 3,000	
775 - COVID Rental Assistance Program	\$ 25,000	\$ 25,000	
Operations Expenses Subtotal	\$ 663,750	\$ 663,750	
Grand Total Expenses	\$ 728,450	\$ 728,450	
Difference	\$ -	\$ -	